128 **Akbar set off on foot from Agra to fulfil a vow:** See *Akbarnama* miniature, 'Akbar receives the news in Agra of the birth of his son Salim'.

128 **the infant Salim also travelled to Ajmer:** Arif Qandahari, *Tarikh-i-Akbari*, p. 163.

128 **'a wise and respectable saint':** Ibid., p. 162.

129 **'trafficking with Kings and conquering their souls':** Quoted in Muzaffar Alam, 'The Mughals, the Sufi Shaikhs and the Formation of the Akbari Dispensation', *Modern Asian Studies*, Vol. 43, No. 1, p. 144.

129 **'There is no precedence of one religion over the other':** Ibid., p. 162.

129 **Akbar did not require these women to convert to Islam:** For a full discussion, see Ruby Lal, *Domesticity and Power*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2005 and Mukhoty, *Daughters of the Sun*.

130 **'ever since the reign of Akbar, it had been ordained':** Mukhia, *Mughals of India*, p. 129.

131 **Rawat Durga Das of Deogarh married strong horse-riding women:** Joshi, *Polygamy and Purdah*, p. 40.

131 **Widow remarriage, also known as nata marriages:** Ramya Sreenivasan, *The Many Lives of a Rajput Queen: Heroic Pasts in India C. 1500-1900*, Washington D. C.: University of Washington Press, 2007, p. 73.

132 **'a form of purdah served to promote':** Molly Emma Aitken, 'Pardah and Portrayal: Rajput Women as Subjects, Patrons, and Collectors', *Artibus Asiae*, Vol. 62, No. 2, 2002, p. 247.

132 **Mughal women were pardeh-giyan, the veiled ones:** Lal, *Domesticity and Power*, p. 176.

132 **'From early youth, in compliment to his wives':** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 269.

133 **'jewelled strings tied on his wrists, by Brahmans, by way of a blessing':** Ibid.

133 **'certain pandering pimps':** Ibid., p. 313.

133 **Akbar, too, started keeping fasts regularly:** Taylor Sen, *Feasts and Fasts*, p. 189.

133 **'Of the austerities practised by my revered father':** Alexander Rogers (trans.), *Tuzuki-Jahangiri or Memoirs of Jahangir*, 2 Vols., edited by H. Beveridge, Delhi: Low Price Publications, 1909–14, 2017 (repr.), p. 45.

133 **vegetarian dishes made for Akbar as noted by Abu'l Fazl included khushka, plain boiled rice:** Taylor Sen, *Feasts and Fasts*, p. 184.

133 **'such as boar cooked with onions, coriander':** Collingham, *Curry*, p. 21.

134 **a favourite was the dal batti churma:** Taylor Sen, *Feasts and Fasts*, p. 251.

134 **Padshah immediately declared that he would never hunt again on a Friday:** George Malleson, *Akbar and the Rise of the Mughal Empire*, 36 Vols., edited by W. W. Hunter, New Delhi: Cosmo Publications, 2001, p. 179.

134 **'in the lodgings of Shaikh Salim':** *The Proceedings of the Indian History Congress*, Vol. 60.

134 **'[Shaikh Salim] allowed the Emperor to have the entree':** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 118.

134 **'either make no friendship with an elephant driver':** Ibid., p. 113.

134 **'to silence the babble of the common throng':** Thackston (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 4, p. 433.

134 **'The Emperor built a lofty palace on the top of the hill of Sikri':** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 112.

134 **'vexatious question' that Akbar's growing harem:** Abu'l Fazl, *Ain-i Akbari*, Vol. 1, translated by H. Blochmann, Calcutta: Asiatic Society of Bengal, 1878, p. 44.

135 **'one of the first Sanskrit works ever to be commissioned by the Mughals':** Audrey Truschke, *Culture of Encounters: Sanskrit at the Mughal Court*, New Delhi: Penguin Books, 2017, p. 119.

135 **The entire world shines with his splendor such that it blinds the eyes:** Ibid., p. 120.